

Regulatory update: Thermal label materials for food applications

Dear Valued Customer,

We would like to inform you about an important regulatory development in the European Union concerning thermal label materials used in food applications.

Regulation (EU) 2024/3190 introduces restrictions on the intentional use of certain bisphenols, including Bisphenol S (BPS), in food contact materials. Thermal coatings fall within the scope of this regulation when labels are applied to food packaging.

This regulation applies specifically to **thermal labels used on food packaging** and does not affect labels intended for logistics, warehousing, or other non-food applications.

What this means for your business

Thermal labels are widely used in applications such as meat, dairy, ready meals, and bakery packaging. If your products are intended for food-contact labelling, these regulatory changes will require a transition to compliant materials.

UPM Adhesive Materials has been **proactively preparing for this change**, ensuring that our portfolio and supply capabilities fully support your transition.

Regulatory timeline

Thermal label materials containing BPS for food packaging may be placed on the market **until July 20, 2026**. After this date, only compliant materials must be used for food applications.

Our readiness and portfolio transition

We have taken comprehensive steps to ensure a **smooth and reliable transition** for our customers:

- **Compliant alternatives are already available** across our portfolio
- **Seamless replacements identified** for affected products
- **Performance and technical specifications maintained**, ensuring no disruption in your operations

- **Clear product categorization** to support correct application use

Our portfolio changes include:

- Certain BPS-containing products will remain available for **non-food applications only** (listed in **Appendix 1** together with their food-compliant alternatives).
- Selected products will be gradually **phased out and replaced with food-compliant alternatives** (please refer to **Appendix 2**).
- Product naming will be **clarified to align fully with food compliance standards**, without impacting performance or specifications (please refer to **Appendix 3**)

Importantly, **all UPM Adhesive Materials products with a food Declaration of Compliance (DoC) fully meet regulatory requirements.**

Supporting your transition

We are committed to making this transition straightforward and predictable for you. Our teams are ready to:

- Help you identify the right compliant alternatives
- Support supply planning and timing
- Ensure continuity in your operations

You can also access our updated portfolio via the [Thermal Label Materials Selection Guide](#).

Next steps

We encourage you to review your current material use and engage with your UPM representative to ensure timely alignment with the new requirements.

Our team is available to help you plan your supply needs. If you have any questions or require support, please do not hesitate to contact your UPM representative.

Best regards,



Sylwia Jurys

Vice President Markets, EMEA

Appendix 1 – Remaining products

Following BPS-containing products will remain in the portfolio without food Declaration of Compliance (DoC) – they will only be suitable for non-food contact applications after July 20, 2026.

Will remain in the portfolio without DoC			Alternative product with food DoC			
Product code	Product description	EAN	Product code	Product description	EAN	New product?
BZE/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE-FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460221	KGE/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788511794	Yes
BZE/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE-FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460269	KGE/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788511817	Yes
GGG/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788278499	HAH/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788376058	No
GGG/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788278505	HAH/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482223	No
GGG/RH9L/FUY	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RH9L / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788303016	HAH/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788376058	No
GGG/RR23/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RR23 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788278529	HAH/RR23/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RR23 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482186	No
GGG/RH9X/FUY	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788278512	HAH/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788376058	No
HHQ/RH9X/FUX	THERMAL TOP LOGISTICS NXT+FSC / RH9X / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788329320	JSG/RH9F/FUX	THERMAL TOP FOOD NXT+FSC / RH9F / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788470848	No
GGG/RP5X/FUY	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788310830	HAH/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482223	No
HHQ/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL TOP LOGISTICS NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482162	JSG/RP5X/FUX	THERMAL TOP FOOD NXT+FSC / RP51 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788486573	No
HHQ/RR23/FUX	THERMAL TOP LOGISTICS NXT+FSC / RR23 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482131	JSG/RR23/FUX	THERMAL TOP FOOD NXT+FSC / RR23 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788486610	No
GGG/RH01/FUY	THERMAL TOP LOGISTICS NXT+FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788479278	KGE/RH01/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788514177	Yes
HHQ/RH01/FUX	THERMAL TOP LOGISTICS NXT+FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788482148	FLG/RH01/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460481	No

Appendix 2 – Phased out products

Following BPS-containing products will be phased out from the portfolio – they will only be suitable for non-food contact applications after July 20, 2026.

Will be phased out			Replacement with food DoC			
Product code	Product description	EAN	Product code	Product description	EAN	New product?
BZE/LW45/03/T2	THERMAL ECO BPAFREE-FSC / RP45 LW / HONEY GLASSINE 65 / HIGH COATWEIGHT	6415788205723	KGE/LW45/FUX/T2	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RP45 LW / HONEY GLASSINE 65 / HIGH COATWEIGHT	6415788514153	Yes
BZE/RH01/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPAFREE-FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460207	KGE/RH01/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RH1 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788514177	Yes
BZE/RP45/03	THERMAL ECO BPAFREE-FSC / RP45 / HONEY GLASSINE 65	6415788318690	KGE/RP45/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RP45 / HONEY GLASSINE 65	6415788514191	Yes
BZE/RP48/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPAFREE-FSC / RP48 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460245	KGE/RP48/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RP48 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788514214	Yes
BZE/RR22/FUX	THERMAL ECO BPAFREE-FSC / RR22 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788460306	KGE/RR22/FUX	THERMAL ECO-FSC / RR22 / HONEY GLASSINE 65-FSC	6415788514238	Yes
GGH/RHR5/FUY	RE ECO BPAFREE NXT+FSC / RHR5 / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788278536	HAI/RHR5/FUY	RETAIL THERMAL ECO NXT+FSC / RHR5 / HONEY GLASSINE 45-FSC	6415788375853	No

Appendix 3 – Product name changes

Historically, the term “TPF” (Total Phenol Free) in product names referred specifically to the thermal coating layer. However, it may be interpreted as applying to the entire laminate structure, which could be misleading. While the thermal layer is phenol-free, other components (such as films or adhesives) may contain trace levels of phenolic NIAS (Non-Intentionally Added Substances) not related to the thermal chemistry. To ensure full transparency and alignment with the food Declaration of Compliance (DoC), we are removing the “TPF” designation from the product names.

In addition, to ensure consistency in our product naming, the designation “BPA-Free” will be replaced by “Logistics.” Products identified as “Logistics” are intended for non-food applications and will not comply with food contact regulations applicable after July 20, 2026 onward.

Please note:

1. This is a clarification of product naming only, EAN codes will remain the same
2. There are no changes to raw materials or formulation
3. Product performance and technical specifications remain unchanged

All UPM Adhesive Materials products with a food Declaration of Compliance (DoC) continue to meet all applicable regulatory requirements, including any potential trace substances.

Face code	Old face description	New face description
BZE	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE-FSC	THERMAL ECO LOGISTICS-FSC
GGG	THERMAL ECO BPA FREE NXT+FSC	THERMAL ECO LOGISTICS NXT+FSC
HAH	THERMAL ECO TP FREE NXT+FSC	THERMAL ECO NXT+ FSC
HAI	RETAIL ECO TP FREE NXT+FSC	RETAIL THERMAL ECO NXT+ FSC
FLG	THERMAL TOP P 200 TPFREE-FSC	THERMAL TOP P200-FSC
IEL	THERMAL TOP P 200 TPFREE-FSC	THERMAL TOP P200-FSC
DFF	THERMAL TOP P 300 TPFREE-FSC	THERMAL TOP P300-FSC
IJZ	THERMAL ECO BPAF NXT+CO2N-FSC	THERMAL ECO LOGISTICS NXT+CO2N-FSC
JSG	THERMAL TOP FOOD NXT+TPF-FSC	THERMAL TOP FOOD NXT+FSC
FWK	LINERLESS TPF-FSC	DT LINERLESS-FSC
KBS	SYNThERMAL TPF	SYNThERMAL PP WHITE PREMIUM
KEQ	SYNThERMAL TPF TAG	SYNThERMAL PP WHITE PREMIUM TAG